the practices of Muslims, who, it is claimed, only provide social support to their co-religionists. Muslims are also cited as being inherently violent and sexually or physically abusive towards women. In addition to the popular narrative that Muslims, and Rohingya in particular, are 'bad guests' (see Nyi Nyi Kyaw 2015, p. 56) a direct contrast is made by many informants between what are seen as Buddhist and Muslim notions of good and meritorious social action. References are frequently made to the atrocities of the Islamic State, communal conflict in Rakhine State, and ritual slaughter of cows at Eid Al-Adha. This discourse of meritorious and non-meritorious social action recurs both in offline discussion and increasingly online, especially on the Facebook pages of major Buddhist welfare groups (as discussed in McCarthy forthcoming b). Taungoo's second-largest non-state welfare provider, Twenty-Four Hours, provides a prominent example of the discursive role these groups now play in the context of Myanmar's rapidly changing telecommunications landscape.[9] Throughout 2015, the group Facebook page, run by a prominent volunteer, vocal NLD supporter, and self-professed founding member of MaBaTha in Taungoo, regularly featured images andstories about people who 'value life' and engage in selfless social action of various sorts. Articles or rumours about assaults and violence committed by Muslims in Myanmar and elsewhere were also shared, including horrific images of communal conflict in Rakhine State or atrocities committed by the Islamic State in the Middle East, frequently with comments emphasizing that Muslims 'do not value life' or are inherently violent.

This discourse echoes pre-existing narratives and sentiments about the allegedly rapid growth of Islam and the decline of Buddhism (see Schissler et al. 2015; McCarthy and Menager 2015) that have played a major role in a series of legislative debates in Myanmar's parliament about the regulation of inter-religious conversion and marriage as well as reproductive rights. By August 2015 a package of four laws, which were written and passed at the urging of MaBaTha and its national network of monks and laity, had passed into law. In the process of this campaign, a particular notion of 'the political' was popularized which extends deep into the intimate domestic domains of marriage, religion in the family, and sexual relations and reproduction. Nationally and locally prominent monks urged voters not to lend their support to political candidates who did not vote for the laws. Some also suggested that the NLD's opposition to the laws implies that the party does not care about the 'protection of national religion'.[10]